THE MASTERMIND COACHING CLASSES

CBSE / RBSE · Nursery – Class XII · Road No. 5, VKIA, Jaipur · 9887258679

CLASS X — ENGLISH LANGUAGE AND LITERATURE (184) · PRACTICE PAPER · SET 05

Session 2026-27 · Mid-Term Pattern

Class: X	Subject: English Language and Literature	Time: 3 Hours	Max. Marks: 80

General Instructions:

1. This question paper comprises 11 questions. All questions are compulsory.
2. The question paper contains THREE sections — Section A: Reading Skills; Section B: Grammar and Writing Skills; Section C: Literature Textbook.
3. Attempt questions based on the specific instructions given for each part.

SECTION A — READING SKILLS — 20 marks

1. Read the following passage. **10**

1. In a small workshop in Assam, a craftsman splits a green bamboo pole into thin strips and begins to weave a basket. His hands move without hesitation, for the skill was passed down from his grandfather. Bamboo, often called the 'poor man's timber', has been used for centuries in India to build houses, make furniture, carry water and fish in the rivers, and in many villages a family's wealth was once counted by the size of its bamboo grove. Today, this humble grass is being seen in a new light as a material for a greener future. Architects have used it to build graceful pavilions and even whole schools, showing that something so ordinary can be both strong and beautiful.

2. The qualities of bamboo explain this change. It is one of the fastest-growing plants on earth, and some varieties grow nearly a metre in a single day. Unlike trees, it does not need to be replanted after cutting, since new shoots arise from the same roots. Its roots also hold the soil together, which prevents landslides on slopes, and it absorbs large amounts of carbon dioxide while giving out more oxygen than many trees of the same size.

3. These advantages have encouraged designers to use bamboo in unexpected ways. Bamboo flooring, toothbrushes, water bottles and even bicycle frames are now sold in cities around the world, and exporters report that orders rise every year. In rural areas, women's groups produce baskets, lamps and mats that are bought by shops and online buyers, and their income allows them to send their children to school.

4. Still, the industry faces many difficulties. Old laws classified bamboo as a tree, which made it hard to cut and transport it, though the rule has been relaxed. Artisans often lack modern tools and training, and they depend on traders who pay low prices. Cheap plastic products also compete with handmade goods, since they cost less and are easier to produce in large numbers. Many young people in craft villages therefore leave for factory jobs in towns, and the skills of generations are in danger of being lost.

5. To protect this craft, experts recommend training centres, fair-trade markets and better designs that appeal to young buyers. When people choose a bamboo product over a plastic one, they support both the forest and the family who made it. In this way, a simple grass can strengthen livelihoods and the environment together. The challenge for the coming years is to make sure that the benefits reach the weaver in the village and not only the businessman in the city.

Created for academic usage / 430 words

Answer the following questions, based on the passage above.

I. Why is bamboo called the 'poor man's timber'? (Paragraph 1) **1**

II. According to Paragraph 2, bamboo helps the environment in all of the following ways EXCEPT **1**

(A) holding the soil together
(B) absorbing carbon dioxide
(C) growing quickly without replanting
(D) providing minerals to the soil

III. Complete the following by selecting the correct option from those in the brackets: Bamboo grows back from its roots after cutting, which makes it a _____ resource. (renewable / scarce) (Paragraph 2) **1**

IV. Select the option that is TRUE according to Paragraph 3. **1**

(A) Bamboo is used only in villages.
(B) Women's groups earn income from bamboo products.
(C) Plastic bottles are replacing bamboo.
(D) Bamboo bicycles are not sold anywhere.

V. Complete the analogy by selecting the correct option. **1**

Training centre : Skill :: Fair-trade market : _____

(A) Fair price
(B) Waste

VI. Why is it difficult for artisans to compete with plastic goods? (Paragraph 4) **2**

VII. What are the main ideas of Paragraph 2 and Paragraph 4? **1**

i. Bamboo has several special qualities.
ii. The bamboo industry faces difficulties.
iii. Bamboo is harmful to the soil.
iv. Plastic should be banned.
v. Artisans are well paid.

Option	Main idea of Paragraph 2	Main idea of Paragraph 4
A	iii	iv
B	ii	i
C	i	ii
D	v	iii

VIII. How does choosing a bamboo product 'support both the forest and the family'? (Paragraph 5) **2**

2. Read the following passage. **10**

1. A survey of 600 students from Classes 8 to 12 studied their participation in sports. The findings were encouraging. About 65% of the students (390) said that they play a sport or exercise at least three times a week, while the other 35% (210) do so less often. Among all the students, cricket was the most popular game with 36% (216), followed by badminton with 20% (120) and football with 14% (84). Surprisingly, only 7% (42) took part in athletics, even though the school has a well-maintained track.

2. The researchers also asked about stress. Among the 390 active students, 70% (273) said that they felt calm and less stressed during examinations, whereas only 84 of the 210 less active students (40%) said the same. Moreover, 150 of the 390 active students (about 38%) were girls, which was lower than the girls' share in the school, pointing to a need for more opportunities for them.

3. Coaches suggest that schools should offer a wider range of games, arrange mixed teams and keep the playground open for an hour after classes. Regular physical activity, they say, builds fitness, teamwork and the confidence to face challenges in the classroom. A few students added that games helped them make friends from other classes, and gave them a happy break from long hours of study.

Created for academic usage / 219 words

Answer the following questions, based on the passage above.

I. Why does the author describe the findings as 'encouraging'? (Paragraph 1) **1**

II. Complete the following by selecting the correct option from the brackets. The most popular game among the students is _____. (cricket / football) (Paragraph 1) **1**

III. Select the option that is TRUE according to Paragraph 2. **1**

(A) Less active students felt calmer.
(B) Active students were more likely to feel calm during examinations.
(C) Most active students were girls.
(D) Stress was not studied.

IV. Which of the following is the best meaning of 'opportunities' as used in Paragraph 2? **1**

(A) Penalties
(B) Chances to take part
(C) Punishments
(D) Obstacles

V. Complete the analogy by selecting the correct option. **1**
Mixed teams : Cooperation :: Coach : _____

(A) Guidance
(B) Confusion

VI. Complete the following appropriately. 120 students play badminton, which is ____ % of the 600 students. (Paragraph 1) **1**

VII. What do the figures 70% and 40% in Paragraph 2 indicate? **1**

VIII. Why do the researchers say there is a need for more opportunities for girls? (Paragraph 2) **1**

IX. According to the coaches, how does regular physical activity help students? Mention any two benefits. (Paragraph 3) **2**

SECTION B — GRAMMAR AND WRITING SKILLS — 20 marks

GRAMMAR — 10

3. Complete any ten of the twelve of the following tasks, as directed. (10 × 1 = 10)

I. Fill in the blank using the correct form of the word in brackets for a school notice: **1**
The teacher praised her _____ (diligent) in completing the project.

II. Identify the error and write the correction. **1**
He do not know the answer to the question.

ERROR	CORRECTION

III. Fill in the blank with the correct form of the verb. **1**
She _____ (live) in Jaipur since 2015.

IV. Read the given statement. **1**
The guide said to the tourists, “You should not touch the monuments.”
Report: The guide told the tourists that _____.

V. Fill in the blank by choosing the correct option. **1**
The teacher was pleased _____ his progress.

(A) of
(B) with
(C) for
(D) from

VI. Report the following. **1**
“Please wait here till I return,” the clerk said to the visitor.
The clerk requested _____.

VII. Complete the sentence by choosing the correct option. **1**
She is interested _____ classical music.

(A) in
(B) on
(C) at
(D) for

VIII. The sentence has an error. Select the option that correctly identifies the error and the correction. **1**
The news were broadcast at nine.

No.	Error	Correction
A.	news	newses
B.	were	was
C.	broadcast	broadcasts
D.	nine	ninth

IX. Report the following question. **1**
“Which book do you prefer?” the librarian asked me.

X. Choose the correct option from the brackets. **1**
I _____ (would / used to) play cricket every evening when I was young.

XI. Fill in the blank with the correct option. **1**
There are _____ apples in the basket; we can make a pie.
(A) enough
(B) much
(C) little
(D) a little

XII. Identify the error and write the correction. **1**
The women's club have organised a fair.

ERROR	CORRECTION

4. Attempt ANY ONE from A and B. **1 × 5 = 5**

A. You are Ananya/Aman, living in Shanti Nagar. The park in your locality is full of weeds and broken benches. Write a letter to the Secretary of the Residents' Welfare Association, in about 120 words, requesting action to restore it.

O R

B. You are Gaurav/Garima, a student of Class X. You want to encourage students to adopt reading habits. Write a letter to the Editor of a youth magazine, in about 120 words, suggesting ways to promote reading among teenagers.

5. Attempt ANY ONE from A and B. **1 × 5 = 5**

A. The school is to choose one student for the 'Best Volunteer' award. **Mira:** regularly helps in the library and organises donation drives, but she is often absent from school events. **Zayn:** attends every event and helps with decoration, but he rarely takes the initiative and waits to be told what to do. Analyse the profiles and decide who deserves the award. (100–120 words)

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B. The table compares two options for a school picnic.

Features	Water Park	Nature Reserve
Cost per student	₹750	₹450
Distance	15 km	60 km
Activities	Rides and pools	Trekking, bird watching
Safety staff	Lifeguards	Forest guides
Learning value	Low	High

Study the data and write an analytical paragraph in 100–120 words comparing the options and recommending the better one for a school picnic.

SECTION C — LITERATURE TEXTBOOK — 40 marks

6. Read the following extracts and answer the questions for any one of the given two, (a) or (b). **5**

(a)

> *Griffin, the stranger wrapped in bandages, arrives at the inn on a snowy evening and demands a room with a fire. He pays little attention to the landlady's questions and spends hours in his room among bottles and tubes. When she complains, he answers rudely, and her curiosity about the strange guest grows with every passing day.*
>
> (Footprints Without Feet — extract adapted)

I. How is Griffin dressed when he arrives? **1**

(A) In uniform
(B) In bandages
(C) In a suit
(D) In a cloak of fur

II. What does Griffin keep in his room? **1**

III. The landlady's attitude towards Griffin is one of _____. **1**

(A) friendship
(B) curiosity
(C) respect
(D) pity

IV. What do Griffin's actions suggest about his character? Answer in about 40 words. **2**

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(b)

> *After ten years of hard work and debt, Matilda meets her old friend again. She looks worn and rough, but she speaks with pride of having paid every franc. When the friend reveals that the necklace had been a cheap imitation, Matilda is left speechless.*
>
> (The Necklace — extract adapted)

I. Whom does Matilda meet? **1**

(A) Her cousin
(B) Her old friend
(C) Her husband
(D) A stranger

II. What did Matilda feel proud of? **1**

III. The twist in the extract is that the necklace was _____. **1**

(A) stolen
(B) an imitation
(C) pure gold
(D) sold

IV. How does the extract bring out the irony of Matilda's situation? Answer in about 40 words. **2**

7. Read the following extracts and answer the questions for any one of the given two, (a) or (b). **5**

(a)

> *A young boy watches his ball roll down the street and into the water. The poet does not offer him another ball. Instead he says the boy must learn that things are lost, and that he will have to stand with his grief and understand the meaning of loss.*
>
> (The Ball Poem — paraphrased)

I. Where did the ball go? **1**

(A) Into a field
(B) Into the water
(C) Into the sky
(D) Under a car

II. Why does the poet not offer the boy another ball? **1**

III. The boy is learning to deal with _____. **1**

(A) laziness
(B) loss and responsibility
(C) anger
(D) friendship

IV. How does the poem present the boy's growing up? Answer in about 40 words. **2**

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(b)

> *The tiger in the zoo walks to and fro behind bars, paying no attention to visitors. At night, in his imagination, he stalks across the village, lurks near the water-hole, and hears the footsteps of men who fear him. His rage burns quietly in his cage.*
>
> (A Tiger in the Zoo — paraphrased)

I. What does the tiger do in the cage? **1**

(A) Sleeps all day
(B) Walks to and fro
(C) Plays
(D) Roars

II. What does the tiger do in his dreams? **1**

III. The phrase 'burns quietly' suggests the tiger's _____. **1**

(A) delight
(B) suppressed anger
(C) weakness
(D) sleepiness

IV. What contrast does the poet draw between the zoo and the wild? Answer in about 40 words. **2**

8. Answer any four of the following five questions in 40–50 words each. (4 × 3 = 12)

I. How does Ausable save himself from Max in 'The Midnight Visitor'? (The Midnight Visitor)

II. Describe the unusual nature of Mijbil's behaviour in his new home. (Mijbil the Otter)

III. How did Ebright's early hobby lead him towards science? (The Making of a Scientist)

IV. What does Mandela mean by saying courage is not the absence of fear? (Nelson Mandela: Long Walk to Freedom)

V. How does Anne's diary show her loneliness? (From the Diary of Anne Frank)

9. Answer any two of the following three questions in 40–50 words each. (2 × 3 = 6)

I. How do the Martians misread the book in 'The Book That Saved the Earth'? (The Book That Saved the Earth)

II. Why was Lencho's faith in God both strong and naive? (A Letter to God)

III. How does Madam's ride on the bus end in 'Madam Rides the Bus'? What does Valli learn? (Madam Rides the Bus)

10. Answer ANY ONE of the following two questions, in about 100–120 words. (1 × 6)

(A) Compare how 'A Tiger in the Zoo' and 'The Trees' use nature to speak about freedom and captivity. (A Tiger in the Zoo / The Trees)

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(B) Compare Mrs Pumphrey and Matilda as characters who pay a price for vanity or excess. (A Triumph of Surgery / The Necklace)

11. Answer ANY ONE of the following two questions, in about 100–120 words. (1 × 6)

(A) 'The Necklace' is a story of pride, loss and irony. Discuss how Matilda's life changes. (The Necklace)

O R

(B) Discuss how Mandela's speech shows his dream for a free South Africa and his belief in forgiveness. (Nelson Mandela: Long Walk to Freedom)